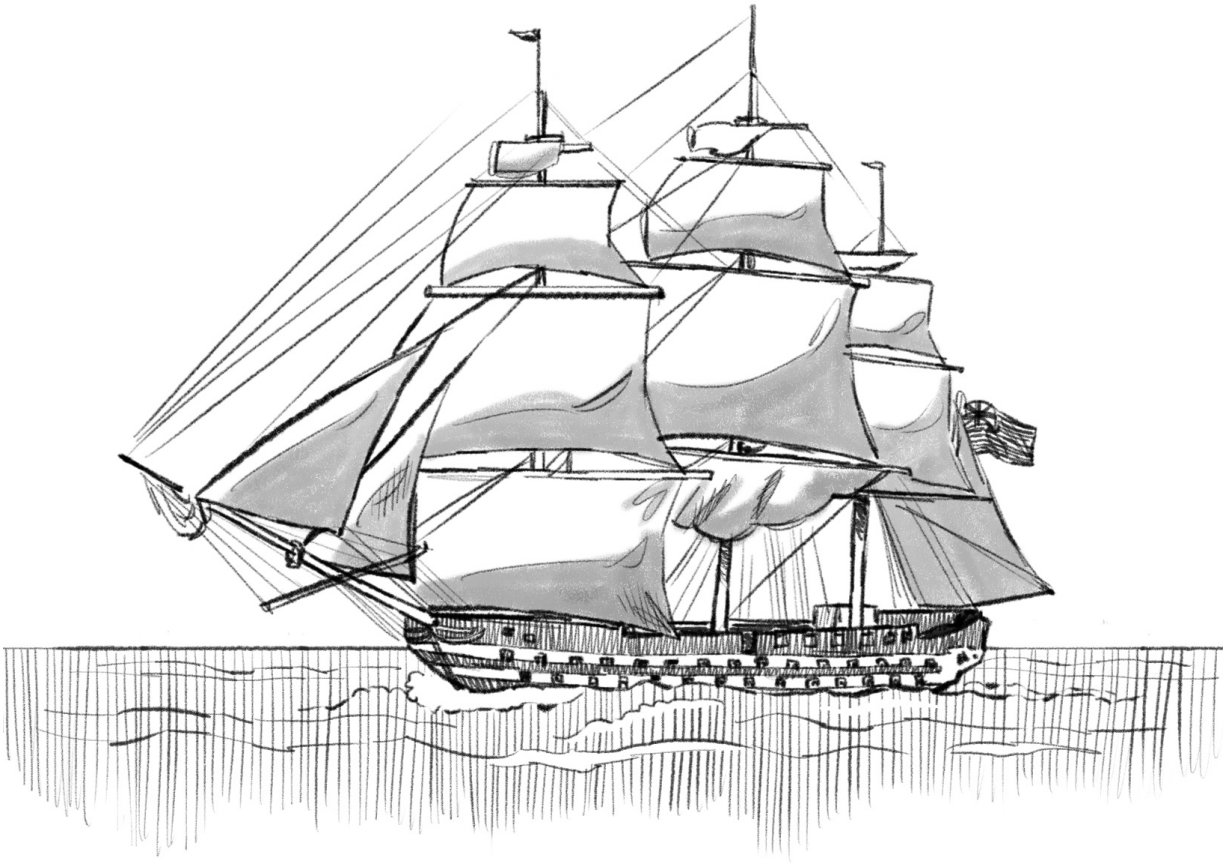


The British had no respect for the historical monuments that the Indian people had built. Even the Taj Mahal was not valued for its beauty. A proposal was made to take apart the building and ship the marble to England. Fortunately, the plan proved too costly and was never carried out.

Local people didn’t treat the Taj Mahal with respect either. In 1754, looters broke into the tombs under the sanctuary and stripped them of all their gold and jewels. People used the Taj Mahal for dances and picnics. Many of the precious stones in the marble walls were chipped out and stolen.